

Information about the Econometrics master

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First things first: Econometrics info moodle

- ▶ Get all important information and updates related to the Econometrics program [here](#)



Second things second: Emailing Christian I

- ▶ wurtz@statistik.tu-dortmund.de
- ▶ Things I can hopefully help you with:
 - Questions about the program structure and course selection
 - Qs about Statistical Theory
 - Qs about other courses I am teaching
 - ... (I'll try my best or at least tell you who can help you instead)
- ▶ Things I cannot help you with:
 - Qs about enrollment
 - Qs about visa, accomodation, status as international student in Dortmund
 - Qs about contents of individual courses that I am not teaching
 - For these: try to contact the International Office, or the research assistants of the responsible chairs

Second things second: Emailing Christian II

- ▶ If you are in doubt who to contact, you can write to me; **BUT** please try looking for the info / contact person on our website(s) first 😊
- ▶ Alternative: [study advisory](#) (most likely, it will end up with me anyways...)

Overview of the Master's program

- ▶ Structure of the program
- ▶ Finding courses
- ▶ Completing the course
- ▶ Duration and credit requirements

Structure of the program: Conditional admission

- ▶ Additional requirements I: Reading course(s)
 - Probability
 - Inference
 - Microeconomics
 - Macroeconomics
- ▶ Additional requirements II: Missing credits in economics
 - Not enough econ, but micro & macro
 - Choice of undergrad econ elective course(s)
 - Details [here](#)
- ▶ Requirements are listed on the admissions offer letter

Structure of the program: The main part

- ▶ 120 ECTS required for completion of the program
- ▶ 39.5 ECTS in mandatory core modules
 - Statistical theory (13.5 ECTS)
 - ☹ Statistical theory course (9 ECTS)
 - Asymptotic theory (4.5 ECTS)
 - Case studies (8 ECTS)
 - Time series analysis (9 ECTS)
 - Econometric theory (9 ECTS)

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 - Case studies (8 ECTS)
 - Time series analysis (9 ECTS)
 - Econometric theory (9 ECTS)
- ▶ Three elective sections:
 - Economics (11-26 ECTS)
 - Applied econometrics (11-26 ECTS)
 - Econometric methods (11-26 ECTS)
- ▶ Master thesis (30 ECTS)
- ▶ Types of courses: lectures and seminars

Finding courses

- ▶ Course catalogue (Vorlesungszeichnis)
- ▶ Each university has one (click the links):
 - TU Dortmund
 - Ruhr-Universität Bochum
 - Universität Duisburg-Essen
- ▶ Moodle rooms:
 - TU Dortmund
 - Ruhr-Universität Bochum
 - Universität Duisburg-Essen
- ▶ Econometrics website
- ▶ Collection of useful links

Which courses can be taken?

- ▶ After finding interesting courses in the catalogues, check the module handbook to see if the course is part of the Econometrics program
 - It is listed: you can take it
 - It is not listed: write to Christian within the deadlines to ask if the course can be added to the program
 - * Winter term: before September 15
 - * Summer term: before March 15

Do I need to register? I

- ▶ Registration to the courses (mostly) not required. Some exceptions: programming courses and lectures offering oral exams
- ▶ Seminars and case studies, however, usually require **timely** registration
- ▶ Registration might differ from department to department
 - Department of Statistics: fill in survey sent by email once per semester
- ▶ Register for the **Moodle room** of each of your courses for material
 - Access key (if required) is given in first lecture and sometimes on the corresponding chair's website or in the course catalogue entry
- ▶ Attendance (mostly) not mandatory

Registering for the exam

- ▶ You **HAVE** to register for exams
- ▶ Registration done in the [Campus Portal](#)
- ▶ Otherwise, you may contact the Central Examinations Office
- ▶ Mr Thomas Bergermann of Team 2 is usually responsible for the Econometrics program
pruefungsverwaltung-statistik@tu-dortmund.de
- ▶ Currently, Miss Karin Vogt is substituting for him

Registering for the exam

- ▶ Registration opens some time in the middle of the semester and can only be done up to two weeks before the exam date
- ▶ De-registering is possible up to one day before the exam
- ▶ Seminars have particular registration requirements
- ▶ Registration may differ for courses not listed in the module handbook

Statistical theory (☺ or ☹?)

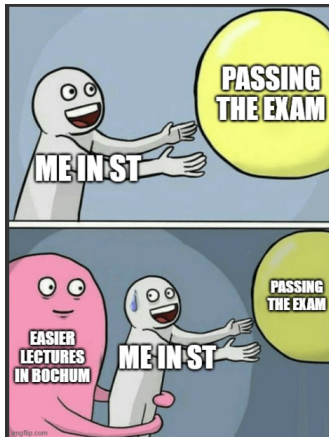
- ▶ Take it early rather than late
- ▶ You get an extra attempt if you try it within your first year! Make use of it! ☺
- ▶ Go through with the lecture even if you feel sad ☹
- ▶ Ask questions as soon as you have them

Me after they introduce sigma algebras in ST



- ▶ We recommend going to the tutorial!
- ▶ Passing is doable, the 1.0 is something else
- ▶ Study **the whole** semester
- ▶ Strongly recommend to not take the two first attempts one after the other
- ▶ Do the exercises and submit them to get feedback
- ▶ Don't leave it as the last lecture (can't stress it enough!!!!!!!!!!!!!!)

Meme



Case studies

- ▶ Seminar where you work in a group
- ▶ Can be quite time-intensive
- ▶ You usually need to submit 2-3 reports (everyone individually)
- ▶ Every group needs to present at least parts of their reports and results
- ▶ Your reports will be graded individually
- ▶ The presentation is usually graded for the entire group
- ▶ Topic and tasks vary from year to year

Case studies

- ▶ Can be substituted with the Data Mining Cup or an external internship
- ▶ The Data Mining Cup is potentially less work, but that may depend on your coding skills and previous experience
- ▶ Barely anyone has tried the internship option
- ▶ As far as we know, the bar is relatively high for the internship to be accepted (so it is not an easy way out)

Tips for case studies

- ▶ As with all seminars, register in time (check your emails)
- ▶ We recommend taking it in the 2nd or 3rd semester
- ▶ Usually, you can choose your group yourself so make sure to find like-minded people to work together with
- ▶ You will need to code a bunch in R (not just in case studies) so familiarize yourself with it asap
- ▶ Also familiarize yourself with $\text{\LaTeX}$ since the reports should really be written in it (applies to all scientific works)

Tips for case studies

- ▶ The results of the reports are of secondary importance; it is important that your results are reproducible, so focus on:
 - Structure (Introduction, Data, Methods, Results, Conclusion)
 - Grammar and readability
 - References/citations
 - Theoretical/mathematical accuracy
 - Proper figures and tables
- ▶ It is tempting to outsource all your work to an AI agent of your choosing, but the professors put bigger emphasis on your **presentations** in times of AI

Master's thesis I

1. Decide whether you want to write an internal or external thesis
2. Find your supervisor and topic (the topics are uploaded on homepages of the professors or [here](#), but it is not a must)
 - If the professor/chair you would like to write your thesis with does not have open topics on their homepage, you can still reach out and ask whether they will supervise your thesis
 - Ideally, you have taken some courses (seminars!) with this professor so you are a bit familiar with the field and the professor has seen you before
3. Find a second supervisor (usually, your first supervisor has some ideas here)

Master's thesis II

4. Once you are ready to register the thesis: write to pruefungsverwaltung-statistik@tu-dortmund.de with your topic and your supervisors
5. In response, you will get a form of Admission to the Master's Thesis Econometrics
 - You have to get the signatures of your two supervisors and from the Chair of the Joint Examination Committee of the Econometrics program (currently: Prof. Demetrescu)
 - Then, you have to send it back to the examinations office **within one week**
6. The official start date is the date on this form

⚠ Disclaimer: This is super important, you won't find this info anywhere. We know it because we suffered. 💀

Extracurricular activities

- ▶ Fachschaft Statistik: Welcome-back party (later), board game nights, Werewolf evenings
- ▶ Sport on Campus
 - Dortmund
 - Essen
 - Bochum
- ▶ Music on Campus ([Website of Uni music](#))
- ▶ Theatre on Campus
- ▶ Yearly "Sommerfest" (summer festival)
- ▶ [International office](#)

Fachschaft information



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Financing your studies

- ▶ Working student positions
- ▶ Research and teaching assistant positions
- ▶ BAföG

Download these slides



Thank you and enjoy
your studies!